



IKS – INDIAN KNOWLEDGE SYSTEMS

UNIT 2 - YOGA BASIC PRACTICES AND PHILOSOPHY

LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR

19th August, 2025

SCOPE OF STUDY

UNIT 2.1

1. Maharshi Patanjali
- 2. Swami Satyananada Sarawati**
3. B.K.S. Iyengar
4. Swami Kuvalayananda
5. Shri Yogendra

UNIT 2.2

1. Body loosening exercises
2. Importance of breath
3. Developing concentration
4. Yoga for mind – body wellness



SWAMI SATYANANDA SARASWATI

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SHANTI PRAYER

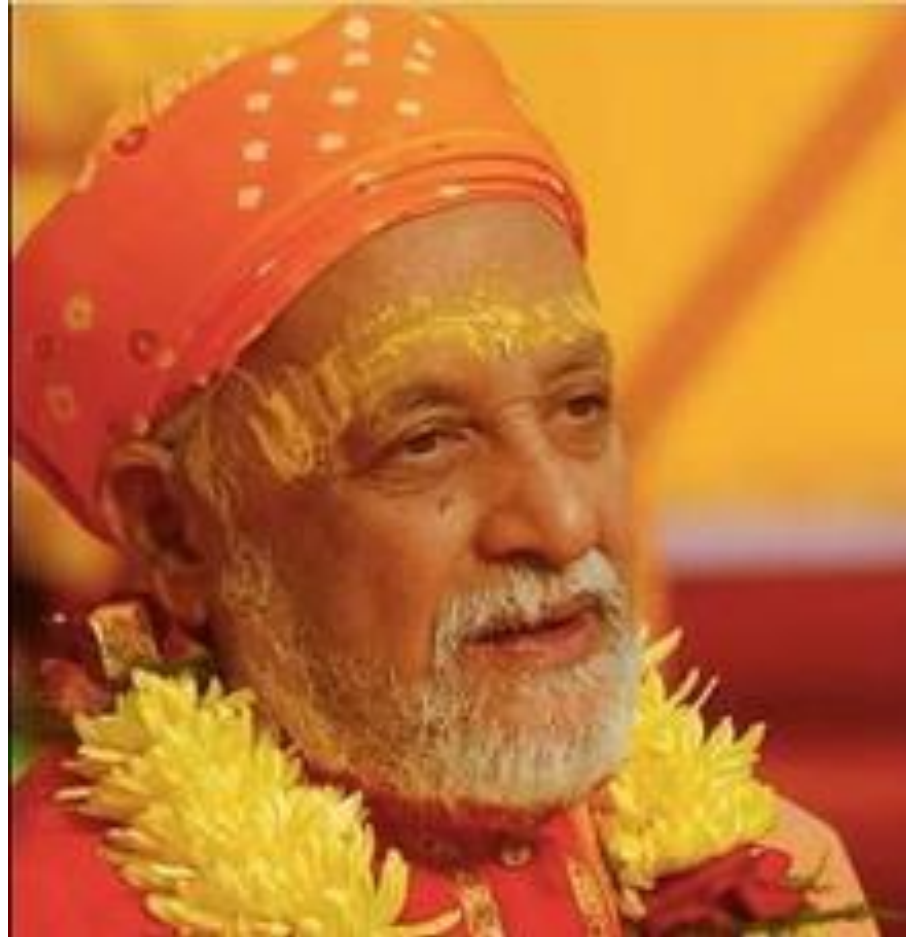
Krishna Yajurveda Taittiriya Upanishad (2.2.2)

ॐ सहनाववतु
सह नौ भुनक्तु
सह वीर्यं करवाव है
तेजस्वि नावधीतमस्तु मा विद्विषाव है
ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

Om Saha nāvavatu
Saha nau bhunaktu
Saha vīryam karavāvahai
Tejasvi nāvadhītamastu
Mā vidviṣāvahai
Om Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ

Om, May we all (Teacher and student) be protected
May we all be nourished
May we work together with great energy
May our intellect be sharpened (may our study be effective) ; Let there be no Animosity amongst us
Om, peace, peace, peace

SWAMI SATYANANDA SARASWATI



SWAMI SATYANANDA SARASWATI



- Born: 25 December 1923 in Almora, Uttarakhand,
- Died: 5 December 2009 in Rikhia, Jharkhand at the age of 86 years
- Known as Founder of Bihar school of Yoga
- Famous for developing Yoga Nidra
- Introduced Integral Yoga – a synthesis of body, mind, emotions and spirit

EARLY LIFE

- Swami Satyanand Saraswati ji was born in 1923 at Almora (Uttaranchal) into a family of farmers and kshatriyas, the warrior caste.
- His ancestors were warriors and many of his kith and kin, including his father, served in the army and police force
- It is claimed that he was classically educated and studied Sanskrit, the Vedas and the Upanishads.
- During early childhood many saints and sadhus blessed him, and foretold that he would have a very developed awareness.
- From young age he displayed signs of spiritual awareness. At the age of six, his awareness spontaneously left the body and he saw himself lying motionless on the floor.

INITIATION INTO SPIRITUALITY

- At age of 18 years, he left his home to seek a spiritual master. It is claimed that he met a tantric bhairavi, Sukhman Giri, who gave him shaktipat and directed him to find a guru to stabilise his spiritual experiences.
- In 1943, at the age of twenty, he met his guru Swami Sivananda Saraswati and went to live at Sivananda's ashram in Rishikesh.
- Sivananda initiated him into the Dashanami Order of Sannyasa on 12 September 1947 on the banks of the Ganges, and gave him the name of Swami Satyananda Saraswati.

SPIRITUAL LEARNINGS

- Swami Satyananda Saraswati immersed himself in Guru seva in those early years at Rishikesh when the ashram was in its infancy and even the basic amenities such as buildings and toilets were absent.
- The ashram work was arduous and difficult which required Swamiji to work long hours in the various departments of the nascent ashram.
- Swamiji says that it was a period of total communion and surrender to the guru tattwa when he lived and served his Guru.
- Swamiji felt that just to hear, speak of or see Sri Swami Sivananda Saraswati was yoga.

LEARNINGS IN SPIRITUALITY

- With the practice of Nishkama seva, Swamiji gained an enlightened understanding of the secrets of spiritual life and became an authority on Yoga, Tantra, Vedanta, Samkhya and Kundalini
- Swami Sivananda said of Swami Satyananda, “Few would exhibit such intense Vairagya at such an early age. Swami Satyananda is full of the Nachiketa element.”
- In 1956, Swami Sivananda Saraswati taught him kriya yoga and gave him the mandate and mission to “spread yoga from door to door and shore to shore”.

SPREADING OF YOGA

- From 1956, basing himself in Munger, Bihar Swamiji wandered as a mendicant throughout India, extending his knowledge of spiritual practices and spending some time in seclusion
- In 1962, Swamiji established the International Yoga Fellowship Movement in Rajnandgaon.
- This inspired the establishment of ashrams and yoga centres spiritually guided by Swami Satyananda in India and around the world.
- From 1963 to 1982, Swamiji took yoga to each and every corner of the world, to people of every caste, creed, religion and nationality.
- He inspired millions of seekers in different countries.

GROWTH OF YOGA

- In 1964, Swamiji founded the Bihar School of Yoga at Munger, with the intention that it would act as a centre of training for future teachers of yoga as well as offer courses on yoga.
- Students from abroad were among those who attended courses at the Bihar School of Yoga.
- Some of these students in turn invited Swamiji to teach in their own countries.
- He lectured and taught for the next twenty years, including tours to Europe, Australia, New Zealand, Japan, Singapore, North America.
- The foreign and expatriate students also established new centres of teaching in their respective countries.

BIHAR SCHOOL OF YOGA, MUNGER



GROWTH OF YOGA

- By 1983, Swamiji's tireless efforts to spread the message of yoga had touched the whole world. Bihar School of Yoga was well established and recognized throughout the world as a reputed and authentic centre for learning yoga and the spiritual sciences.
- At the peak of his accomplishment, Sri Swami Satyananda appointed Swami Niranjanananda as his successor and gave him the mandate to continue the work.
- Swami Satyananda then gradually withdrew from all activities and in 1988, he left Munger to begin a new phase of his life as a sannyasin.

LATER LIFE

- Swami Satyananda arrived at Rikhia on 23rd September 1989, at mid-day, the day of vernal equinox, when nature is in perfect balance as the day and night are equal.
- Soon after, he lit a dhuni or fire and called it Mahakaal Chita Dhuni.
- He began a life of intensive spiritual practice, entering the lifestyle of Paramahamsas.
- Seeking to strike a balance between the personal aspect of spiritual liberation and the social aspect of helping others,
- Swamiji was guided by a new inspiration: service to and improvement of the living conditions of the tribal people in the thousands of villages surrounding Rikhiadham.

LATER LIFE

- In 1994, in a month-long darshan, Swamiji gave the message of bhakti yoga. He said that the purpose of human life is to realize God through love and to serve God by helping humanity.
- He prophesied that while Hatha yoga and Raja yoga were the panacea of the twentieth century, devotion to God and Bhakti yoga would be the panacea of the twenty-first.
- In 2007, Swamiji announced Rikhiapeeth as an ashram where the three cardinal teachings of Sri Swami Sivananda - serve, love and give - were to be practised and lived

RIKHIAPEETH ASHRAM, DEOGHAR



MAHASAMADHI

- In 2009, after participating in and giving darshan during Sat Chandi Mahayajna and Yoga Poornima Swamiji inspired everyone to lead the righteous life
- Sri Swamiji wilfully entered into Mahasamadhi on the midnight of 5th December 2009 and merged into Shiva consciousness.
- His mortal remains were buried in the earth at Tulsi Kutir
- Rikhiapeeth is considered as his "tapobhoomi" (abode of austerity) and the place where he fulfilled the instructions of his guru, Swami Sivananda, "to serve, love and give"

CONTRIBUTION TO YOGA

- Swamiji embarked upon an immense campaign of printing and publishing to fulfill the mandate of his guru and spread the light of yoga to every corner of the globe.
- In 1963, Bihar School of Yoga first published the magazine Yoga in English and Yoga Vidya in Hindi
- Swamiji wrote over 80 books, including in 1969 the popular manual Asana Pranayama Mudra Bandha
- Swamiji's writings have been published by the Bihar School of Yoga and by the Yoga Publications Trust established by his disciple Swami Niranjanananda

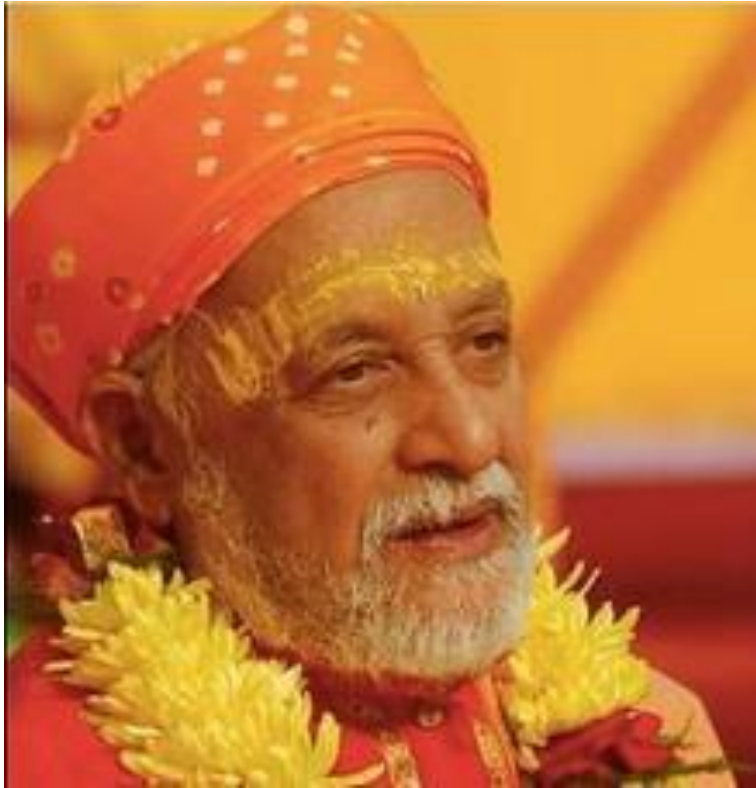
SATYANANDA YOGA

- The Yoga of the Bihar School of Yoga is also called as Satyananda Yoga
- It is the integration of all aspects of yoga into a systematic approach to achieve a balanced evolution and wholeness.
- Its foundation is the fundamental yogas (hatha yoga, raja yoga, jnana yoga, bhakti yoga and karma yoga) to develop the faculties of head, heart and hands.
- Yoga practices were made accessible to ordinary people in a practical, safe and effective form. Simple practices are suitable for all and when practised regularly, lead to transformative experiences
- Mantra yoga, nada yoga, kriya yoga, kundalini yoga, laya yoga are also part of the system

SATYANANDA YOGA

- Awareness lies at the heart of all Bihar Yoga / Satyananda Yoga practices and its entire approach.
- Swamiji emphasized the importance of bringing awareness into each dimension of every yoga practice – the physical, mental, emotional, energetic, subtle and spiritual. This allows the awareness to gradually expand, so that over time awareness can be brought into all the activities and aspects of life.
- Swamiji taught that the expansion and cultivation of awareness should be the aim of life and the means for that is yoga.

SWAMI SATYANANDA SARASWATI



- **Janmabhoomi** Born: 25 December **1923** in **Almora, 1943 – Gurubhoomi** was in **Rishikesh**
- **1963 – Karmabhoomi** in **Munger Yoga Nidra**
- **1983 – Towards Destiny**
- **1989 – Tapobhoomi** in **Rikhia**
- **2007 -Tirtha Yatra**
- **Mahasamadhi: 5 December 2009** in **Rikhia, Jharkhand**

GURUS OF BIHAR SCHOOL OF YOGA





THANK YOU